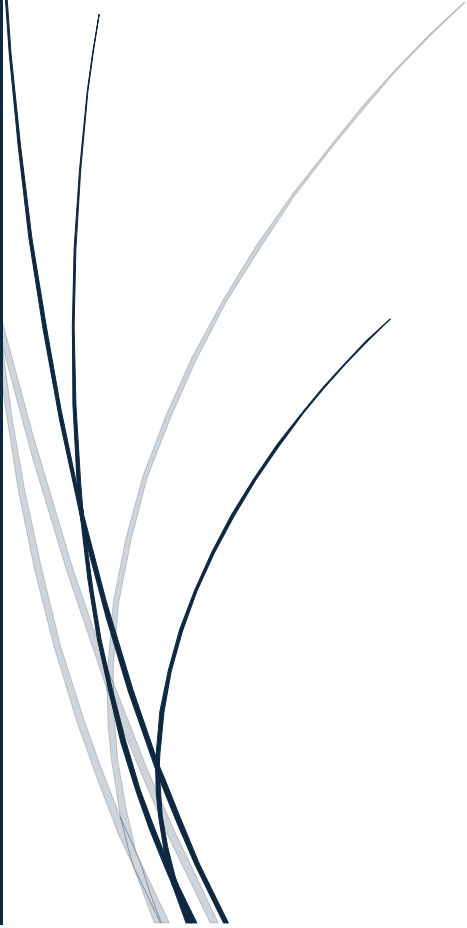




19/05/2026

IAPT Referral-to-Treatment Waiting Time Analysis

Dataset:- IAPT Waiting Times — NHS



PREPARED BY:- MUKESH RAJ
DATA ANALYTICS INTERN

Project Objective

This analysis examines **IAPT referral-to-treatment waiting times** using the 2024–25 psychological therapies dataset. The main objective was to calculate and visualise mean RTT waiting times by:

- NHS commissioning region
- waiting-time category
- estimated disorder type

Dataset Overview

The merged dataset contained:

Metric	Value
Total rows	92,137
Total columns	171
Final cleaned columns	47
High-missing columns removed	124
Missing values after cleaning	0

The dataset contained organisation-level IAPT activity, waiting-time indicators, treatment counts, therapy type variables, and presenting complaint/disorder categories.

Data Cleaning Summary

The following cleaning steps were completed:

- Removed special missing symbols such as *, -, blank cells, and NULL.
- Standardised column names.
- Removed columns with more than 80% missing values.
- Filled categorical missing values with "Unknown".
- Converted waiting-time and count columns into numeric format.
- Removed invalid region rows such as UNKNOWN and national aggregate row All.
- Filtered analysis to NHS **Commissioning Region** level.

Regional RTT Findings

The analysis used:

Mean_WaitAccessingServices

as the main RTT waiting-time measure.

Region	Mean RTT
North West Commissioning Region	41.40
South West Commissioning Region	37.70
London Commissioning Region	35.65
Midlands Commissioning Region	34.05
South East Commissioning Region	33.15
North East and Yorkshire Commissioning Region	32.05
East of England Commissioning Region	31.70

Waiting-Time Category Findings

Two waiting-time categories were identified:

Waiting Type	Mean RTT Access	Mean RTT Finished
Accessing services	21.50	20.27
First to Second treatment	48.70	68.01

Disorder-Type RTT Analysis

Direct disorder-specific RTT values were not available in the dataset because **Presenting Complaint rows did not contain usable RTT waiting-time values.**

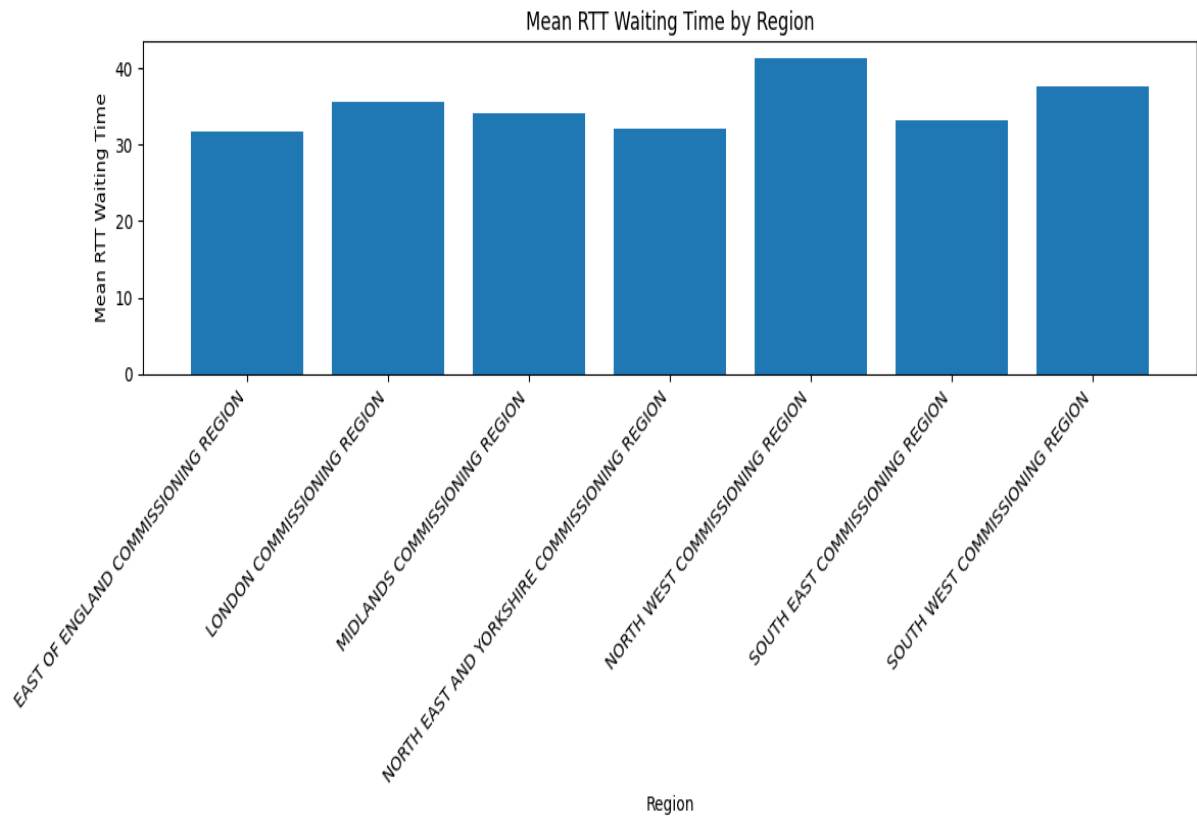
To still complete the required task, an estimated disorder-level RTT was calculated by weighting regional RTT averages using disorder-specific finished-treatment counts.

Disorder Type	Estimated Mean RTT
Not stated/Not known/Invalid	35.76
Other Mental Health problems	35.09
Medically Unexplained Symptoms	34.85
Other recorded problems	34.84
Anxiety and stress related disorders	34.83
Depression	34.66
All AD/SM	34.66

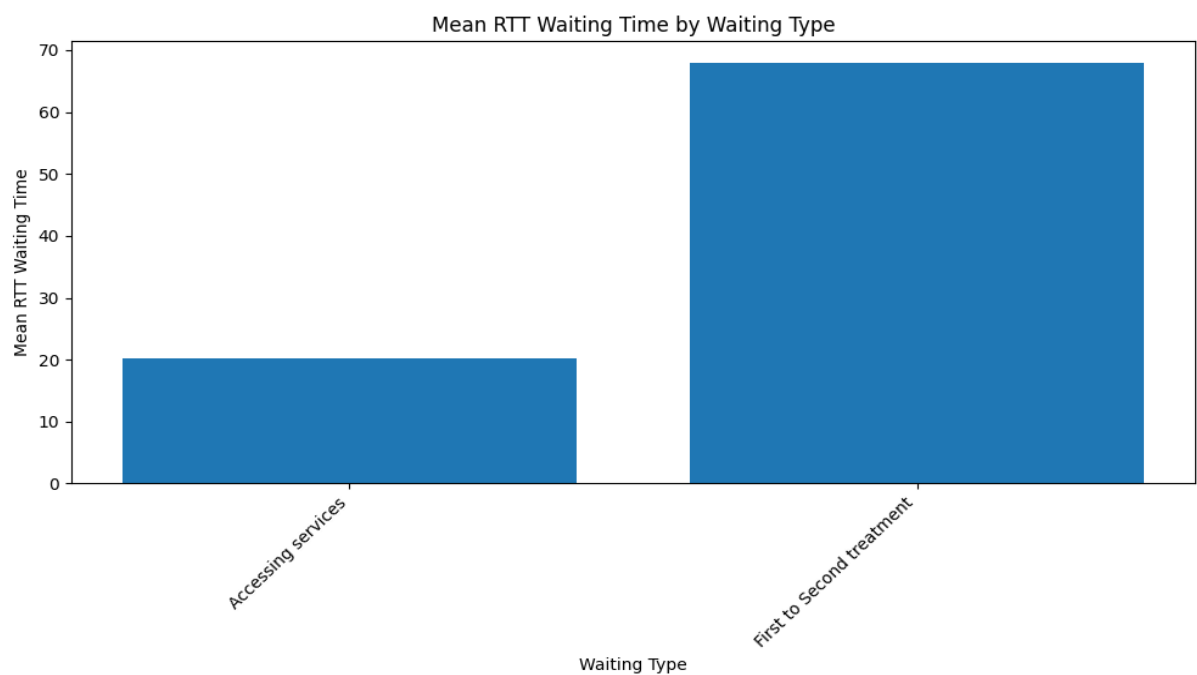
Charts Produced

The notebook produced the following visual outputs:

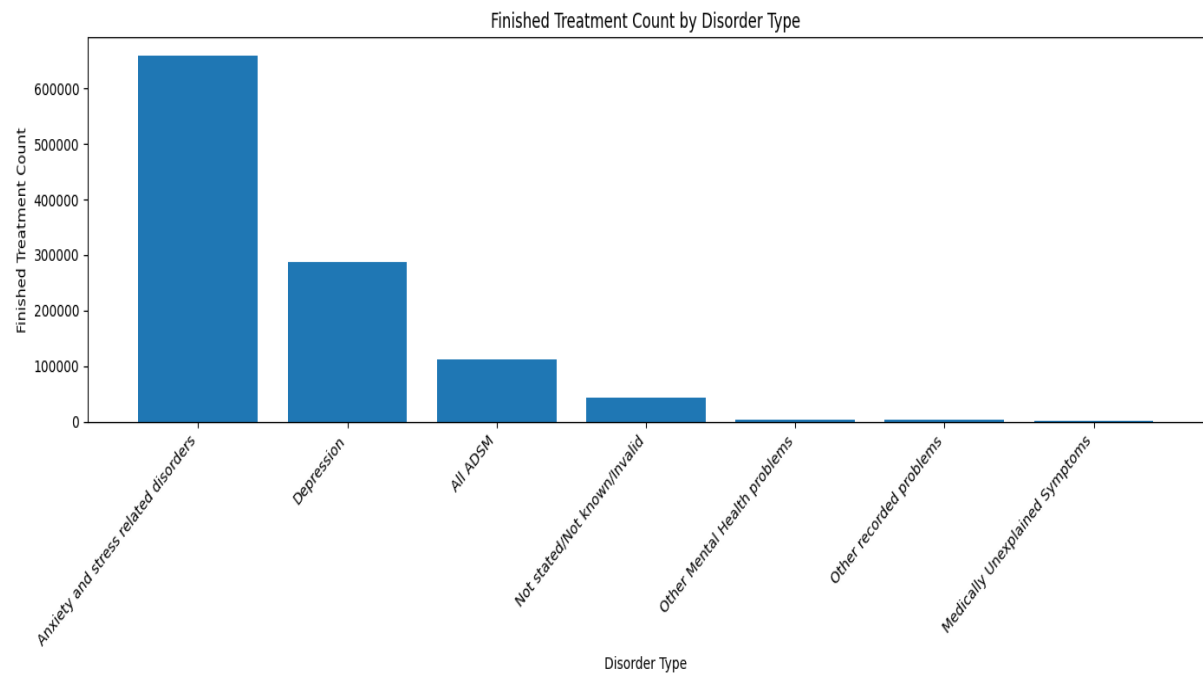
- Mean RTT waiting time by region



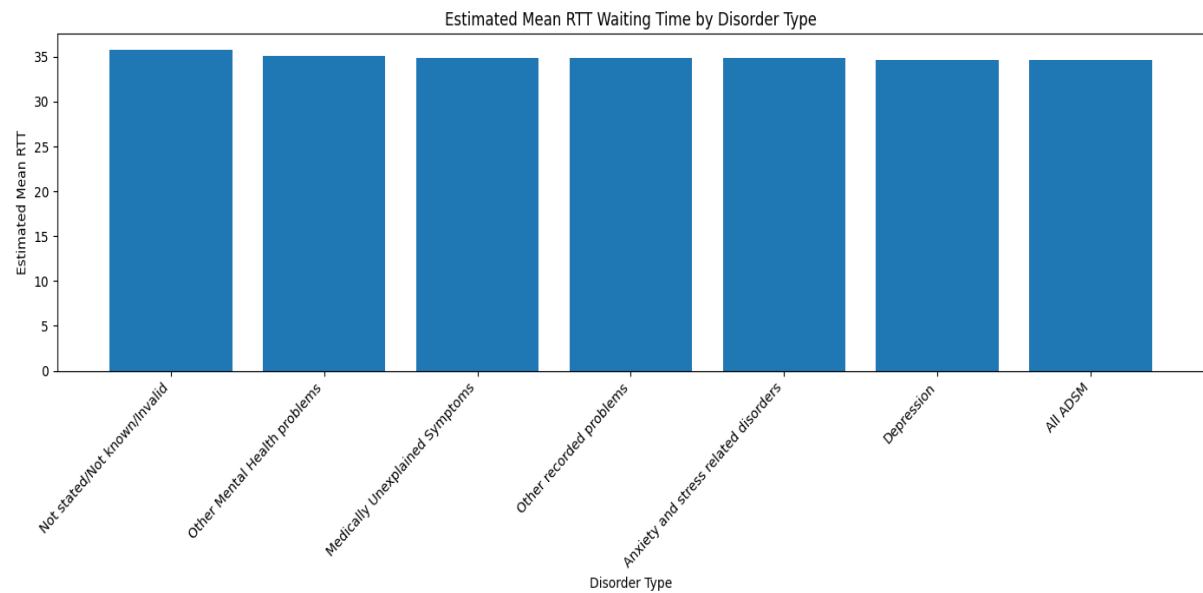
- Mean RTT waiting time by waiting type



- Finished treatment count by disorder type



- Estimated mean RTT waiting time by disorder type



Limitations

This analysis has one important limitation:

Disorder-level RTT was not directly available in the dataset. Therefore, disorder-type RTT was estimated using a weighted regional approach. This should be interpreted as an **exploratory estimate**, not an official direct NHS RTT measure.

Conclusion

The analysis shows clear regional variation in IAPT waiting times. The North West had the longest average RTT, while East of England had the shortest. Waiting between first and second treatment was substantially longer than initial access waiting time. Disorder-specific RTT could not be directly calculated from the raw dataset, so an estimated weighted method was used to provide an approximate disorder-level comparison.